BUILD PLAN

Xero Auto-Invoice Platform From single workflow to multi-user product

A step-by-step plan for turning the working "Xero flow" n8n automation into a product other people can sign up for — starting with Google and Xero login.

Prepared for Sarita-Jo Ryder · 4 August 2026

PHASE 0 · ALREADY DONE

The core automation works

This is the foundation everything else builds on — confirmed working end-to-end for a single Xero organisation.

✓ **Gmail Trigger polls for bills**

Watches for incoming email with an attachment matching invoice/bill/receipt.

✓ **Email parsing**

Extracts sender name, sender email, and subject from the raw email.

✓ **Xero contact matching + fallback creation**

Looks up the sender as an existing Xero contact; creates a new contact automatically if none exists.

✓ **Draft bill creation + attachment upload**

Creates a draft ACCPAY invoice in Xero and attaches the original PDF.

PHASE 1 · ONE-TIME SETUP, DONE BY YOU

Register your two OAuth apps

This step happens once, in your own developer accounts — never per user. It's the thing that lets end users click "Sign in with Google" / "Connect Xero" without touching any settings themselves.

1 **Create a Google Cloud project**

console.cloud.google.com → new project → enable the Gmail API.

2 **Configure the OAuth consent screen**

App name, support email, scopes (gmail.readonly), and your own account added as a test user.

3 **Create an OAuth Client ID (Web application)**

Add your app's redirect URL. Save the Client ID and Client Secret somewhere safe — they go into the app's environment variables, never into code.

4 **Create a Xero Developer app**

developer.xero.com → My Apps → New app (Web app). Set the redirect URL, note the Client ID/Secret, and select scopes: accounting.transactions, accounting.contacts, accounting.attachments, offline_access.

> **Know the caps before you scale:** Google limits unverified apps to ~100 test users and requires an extra security review (CASA) before Gmail scopes go fully public. Xero limits unreviewed apps to a small number of live connections until you submit for app review. Neither blocks you from building or testing now.

PHASE 2

Build the sign-up UI

Next.js + Tailwind. A clean page where a new user creates an account, then connects Google and Xero — nothing more.

1. **Scaffold the app**
   Next.js project with Tailwind, a landing page, and a simple auth system for your own users (e.g. Clerk or Supabase Auth) so each person has an account.

2. **"Connect Google" button**
   Starts the Google OAuth flow; on return, exchanges the code for tokens server-side and stores them against that user's account.

3. **"Connect Xero" button**
   Same pattern for Xero — also captures which Xero organisation(s) the user authorized.

4. **Status screen**
   Shows "Google: connected", "Xero: connected", and a final "Activate automation" action.

PHASE 3

Provisioning backend

The invisible step that turns "user clicked connect" into "their own working automation."

1. **Create the user's credentials in n8n**
   One Gmail OAuth2 credential, one Xero OAuth2 credential, created via the n8n API using the tokens captured in Phase 2.

2. **Clone the master workflow**
   Duplicate the working "Xero flow" template, then rewire every node to the new user's credentials and their Xero organisation ID.

3. **Activate and record**
   Turn the clone on, and store a mapping of user → workflow ID so it can be paused, updated, or removed later.

> Each user gets their own isolated copy of the automation. This is the simplest model to start with — the tradeoff is that future bug fixes or feature changes need to be re-applied to every clone, which Phase 5 accounts for.

PHASE 4

Test with a second real user

Before anyone else touches this, prove the clone works exactly like the original — end to end, not just "it looks right."

- [ ] Connect a second Gmail + Xero account through the UI (a test account you control)
- [ ] Send a real test bill email with a PDF attachment
- [ ] Confirm the clone finds/creates the contact correctly
- [ ] Confirm the draft bill appears in the second Xero org with the attachment
- [ ] Confirm the original account's data was never touched

PHASE 5

Production readiness

What needs to be true before real strangers start connecting their accounts.

- [ ] Google OAuth verification + CASA security assessment submitted (needed once you're past ~100 users)
- [ ] Xero app review submitted (needed to go past the unreviewed connection cap)
- [ ] Privacy policy + terms of service published (required by both Google and Xero review)
- [ ] Per-user error monitoring — know when someone's automation fails, before they tell you
- [ ] A defined process for propagating workflow fixes to every user's clone

PHASE 6

Launch

Once Phase 5 is checked off, open sign-ups. Billing (if this becomes paid) is intentionally left out of this plan — worth its own pass once there's real user demand.